Range

Exam code: 0607

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Updated on 20 January 2026

Range

What is the range?

- The **range** is the **difference** between the **highest value** and the **lowest value**
  - range = highest - lowest
    - For example, the range of 1, 2, 5, 8 is 8 - 1 = 7
- It measures how **spread out** the data is
  - Ranges of different data sets can be **compared** to see which is more spread out
- Be careful with **negatives**
  - The range of -2, -1, 0, 4 is 4 - (-2) = 6

How do I know when to use the range?

- The **range** is a simple measure of how **spread out** the data is
  - The range does **not** measure an average value
- It should **not** be used if there are any **extreme values** (outliers)
  - For example, the range of 1, 2, 5, 80 is 80 - 1 = 79
    - This is not a good measure of spread
    - The range is affected by extreme values

Help me understand

Examiner Tips and Tricks

- If asked to find the range in an exam, make sure you show your subtraction clearly (don't just write down the answer).

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Worked Example

Find the range of the following data.

3.4	3.2	4.0	3.7	3.6	2.8	3.9	3.1	3.0

Answer:

Range = highest value - lowest value

9.2 - 2.8

The range is 6.4

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